

Orpheus and Eurydice

Orpheus was the most skilled musician on Earth. He sang sweeter than a nightingale, and he could play any instrument expertly.



Apollo gave Orpheus his own lyre to play.

The god Apollo even gave his lyre to Orpheus so that he could hear what music Orpheus would create with it. Orpheus was also married to a young woman named Eurydice, whom he loved with all his heart.

One day, Eurydice was out picking flowers. All was well until she reached for a delicate bloom and startled a poisonous snake, which bit her. When she did not return home, Orpheus went to look for her, but it was already too late.

Eurydice's soul had passed into the underworld.

Orpheus was distraught. From that day on, he played only mournful music. It was filled with so much sadness that even the gods felt pity for him. In fact, they felt so sorry for Orpheus that they allowed him an audience with Hades in the underworld.

"Please, Hades," Orpheus begged, "return Eurydice to me. I can't live without her."

Hades grumbled, "I can't just let every soul out of the underworld because their family asks me to. Imagine the chaos above if I did!"

